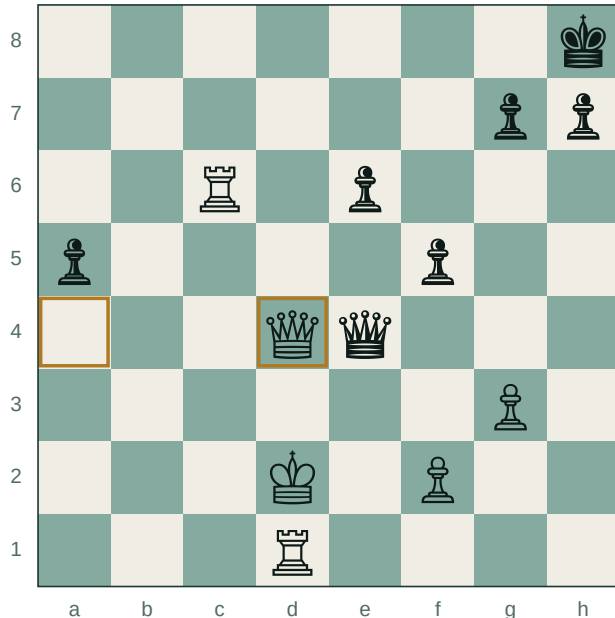


Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 47

Loose-piece tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 47.Qxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

47...Qxd4+ 48. Kc1 Qa1+

47...Qxd4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on d4. Recorded reply: **48.Kc1**.

48...Qa1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -7 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on d2. Geometrically undefended: rook on c6 and queen on d4. Check for tactical protection.